

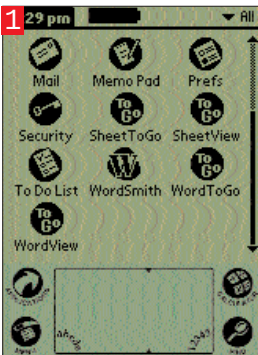
can easily make those last minute changes to your presentation or report while you're en route to your office.

Documents on-the-go

Documents To Go is one of the many tools that can be used for transferring and working with familiar Office formats (Word, Excel and PowerPoint) on your handheld, and then synchronise them with your PC. Here, porting files from your desktop to your handheld is as simple as dragging-and-dropping; this lets you transfer reports and presentations in the process of synchronising your handheld with your computer.

Step 1: Installing the software onto your desktop

Before you begin transferring files to your handheld, you will need to install the desktop component of the document editing software. After



Applications installed on the Palm

downloading the appropriate software, run the setup. During the installation process, the files that need to be transferred to your Palm also get copied to your Palm desktop client application. These applications are saved as .prc files on your computer.

When you synchronise your Palm, the

applications will get copied onto your handheld and you will be able to see them the next time you switch it on.

Step 2: Choosing the documents that you want to transfer

In most document editing applications for handhelds, you can drag and drop the files you want to transfer directly into the applications and they

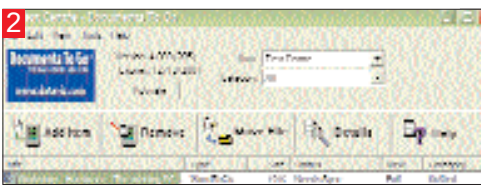
<http://www.dataviz.com>
Home of the 'Documents To Go' application

www.bluenomad.com
Find the WordSmith document editing application for Palm handhelds here

www.synsolutions.com/software/slideshowcommander
Take control of your PowerPoint presentations—right from your Palm

<http://visionary2000.com/qed>
A word processor for the Palm

www.landware.com/takenote/index.html
A text editor for the Palm.



get appropriately converted. During this process, the application converts your document to a format that can be interpreted and read by your handheld. It is reformatted to fit your Palm screen and the fonts used are also converted to a format that can be displayed on your handheld. This done, the file is ready for transfer to your handheld.

Step 3: Transferring applications when you HotSync

Transferring files to your handheld is as simple as docking the handheld and synchronising it. In the case of a Palm handheld, you will simply need to insert your Palm into the cradle and hit the HotSync button. Other handheld devices may have to be connected to the computer using a cable that links the device to one of the ports. This will transfer your document files over to your handheld and the status will be shown as a progress indicator.

Step 4: Working with applications

Launch the 'To Go' documents application on your Palm by tapping on the icon and you will see a list of the documents that have been transferred onto your Palm. Simply tap on the appropriate filename and get set to read and edit the document in your Palm.

You can work on these documents as you would on your desktop. You can use the standard editing and text entering methods for your Palm (if you have a portable keyboard for your Palm, you'll be able to work a lot faster). You can also use the special formatting tools that the application offers you, including tools that let you change formatting, make text bold, italicise and even change the fonts. After you've finished, you can save it on your handheld and keep it ready for synchronising back with your desktop computer. You can choose to overwrite the original document on your desktop.

While we have taken the example of a Word document, these applications are also capable of working with other files such as Excel spreadsheets and PowerPoint presentations.

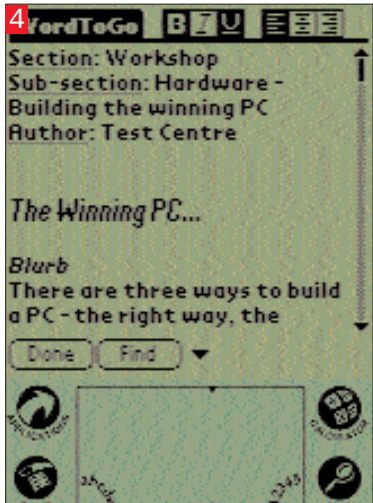
With these document editing software for your handheld, you can now extend your desktop to your car, train or any place on the road and keep your critical documents close at hand at all times. And best of all, you won't have to settle for those drab Courier fonts.



The source document (right) selected for transferring in the application (left)



Transferring the documents to the Palm by synchronising



Voila! The original document is now transferred to the Palm